



BOURSIERS
**McCall
MacBain**
SCHOLARS

International University Endorsement: Open Process

Introduction

A student or graduate of your university is interested in applying for the 2027 cohort of McCall MacBain Scholars at McGill. This document provides information on the criteria and endorsement process for the **head of a university (President, Vice-Chancellor, Rector, or Provost)**. If you do not occupy one of those roles, please ask the candidate to redirect the request to the appropriate individual.

Your university may endorse **up to two Canadian applicants** (Canadian citizens, Canadian permanent residents, or those with accepted refugee status in Canada) and **one international applicant** (without any of the above Canadian statuses).

For **Canadian applicants**, current students and recent graduates (those who graduated in 2024, 2025, or 2026) must earn the endorsement of their institution to be considered for this scholarship. Canadian applicants who graduated in 2023 or earlier apply directly without an endorsement.

International applicants, regardless of graduation year, must also earn the endorsement of their institution as part of the application process.

Canadian Status	Status at Your Institution	Endorsements	Endorsement Deadline	Scholarships Available
Canadian applicants <i>Canadian citizenship, Canadian permanent residency, or accepted refugee status in Canada</i>	Current student or recent graduate (2024, 2025, 2026)	Two (2)	September 23, 2026 4:00 PM Eastern Time	20 McCall MacBain Scholarships (full funding) 30 Finalist Awards of C\$10,000 30 Regional Awards of C\$5,000
	Graduated in 2023 or earlier	Not applicable		
International applicants <i>All other applicants</i>	Any graduation year	One (1)	August 19, 2026 4:00 PM Eastern Time	10 McCall MacBain Scholarships (full funding) 25 Finalist Awards of C\$20,000 per year, renewable for up to two years 15 Regional Awards of C\$10,000

Applicants who require and do not obtain a university endorsement will not be considered for the scholarship.

What are the McCall MacBain Scholarships at McGill?

The McCall MacBain Scholarship provides exceptional students with mentorship, coaching, a leadership curriculum, and funding to pursue an eligible master's or professional degree at McGill University in Montreal, Quebec, Canada. The full scholarship covers tuition and fees, a living stipend of C\$2,300 per month during academic terms, a one-time relocation grant, and summer funding options.

Different scholarships are available based on the applicant's status in Canada. Up to 30 McCall MacBain Scholarships and 100 additional awards, ranging from C\$5,000 to C\$40,000, will be available for Summer/Fall 2027 entry to McGill.

Canadian Status	Scholarships Available	Endorsement Deadline
Canadian Applicants <i>Canadian citizenship, Canadian permanent residency, or accepted refugee status in Canada</i>	20 McCall MacBain Scholarships (full funding) 30 Finalist Awards of C\$10,000 30 Regional Awards of C\$5,000	September 23, 2026 4:00 PM Eastern Time
International applicants All other applicants	10 McCall MacBain Scholarships (full funding) 25 Finalist Awards of C\$20,000 per year, renewable for up to two years 15 Regional Awards of C\$10,000	August 19, 2026 4:00 PM Eastern Time

Who is eligible?

The candidate must meet one of the following criteria:

- Be a current student on track to complete their first undergraduate degree by August 2027
- Have completed their first undergraduate degree in the last five years (January 2021 or later)
- Have completed their first undergraduate degree before 2021, and were 30 years or younger on January 1st, 2026

McCall MacBain Scholarship applicants will also need to meet the degree and language requirements specified by McGill University for master's program admission, as well as any admission requirements for their intended programs of study. The requirements can be found at mcgill.ca/gradapplicants/how-apply.

What does the endorsement mean?

When you endorse a candidate, you tell us that you consider the applicant to be a suitable candidate for the McCall MacBain Scholarships at McGill, one that you would be proud to have represent your institution. The scholarship criteria are exceptional character, track record of community engagement, leadership potential, entrepreneurial spirit, academic strength, and intellectual curiosity. An endorsed candidate must be in good standing, in terms of academics and overall conduct, at your institution.

How can I help my student put together a strong application?

While applicants may seek general advice, they will be asked to certify that what they are submitting is their own work in their own words, and that it has not been edited by anyone other than them. This does not preclude you from reading a draft application and having a conversation with the student about how they might improve it. It does, however, mean that you should not be editing/wordsmithing. The prose should come from them. Applicants are encouraged to consult our website (mccallmacbainscholars.org) and ask questions during online information sessions. They may also email our team at info@mccallmacbainscholars.org.

UNIVERSITY ENDORSEMENT INSTRUCTIONS

How do I endorse the applicant?

The applicant must initiate the endorsement request. After the applicant enters your name and email address into the system, you will receive an email from info@mccallmacbainscholars.org with a link to the online form.

The applicant must separately email you a draft copy of their application for your review. They can download the PDF file from the Confirmation page of their online application.

As the endorser, you will be asked to:

- Confirm your position as head of your university (President, Vice-Chancellor, Rector, Provost)
- Confirm that you have read the draft application
- Confirm that you endorse the application
- Describe the process undertaken at your institution to endorse an applicant for this scholarship. How many potential applicants were considered, who was involved, and what criteria were employed?
(maximum of 50 words)
- Explain how this applicant meets the criteria of exceptional character, community engagement, leadership potential, entrepreneurial spirit, academic strength, and intellectual curiosity.
(maximum of 50 words)
- Enter the applicant's GPA on a 4.0 scale for their studies at your institution

When do I endorse the applicant?

You must submit your endorsement decisions by August 19th (international applicants) or September 23rd (Canadian applicants) at 4:00 PM Eastern Time.

Do I have to provide an institutional letter of support for a candidate being endorsed?

No, an institutional letter of support is not required and will not be considered.

Will the applicant be notified of my endorsement decision?

The applicant will be notified via email when you complete the university endorsement form. The endorsement comments are not viewable by the applicant.

What happens next?

Endorsed applications will be reviewed by the relevant regional selection committee. The top candidates will be invited to regional interviews. Applicants who are successful at this stage will be notified by email approximately two weeks before the relevant interview date. The regional interview dates can be found here: mccallmacbainscholars.org/regional-interviews.